

YET

TEXT: Zechariah 8:20 (NIV) *“This is what the LORD Almighty says: “Many peoples and the inhabitants of many cities will yet come.”*

Romans 8:24-25 (NIV) *“...hope that is seen is no hope at all. Who hopes for what they already have? 25 But if we hope for what we do not yet have, we wait for it patiently.”*

INTRO: On the surface these verses seem to have nothing in common. The word “*yet*” is the common denominator. Though “*yet*” is a tiny one syllable word it packs a big punch. The word YET is used 395 times in the Bible! YET is a:

- Antidote for worry...
- A response of faith...

In the story of Job the word YET is used twenty eight times! Job 13:15 *“Though God*

slay me, YET I will trust Him!” Job 19:26
“If worms devour my skin, YET I will see
God!” In the story of Job God acted! Job got
double for his trouble! He was seventy when
the trial began and he lived to be two
hundred and ten years old!

This little word is the difference between:

- Fear and faith...
- Sadness and joy...
- Hopelessness and hope...
- Worry and confidence...
- Perplexity and peace...

When we insert the word YET into the
craziness of our lives, we are stating that we
know God is going to come through for us.

Think of this:

**I. GOD INTENDS TO DO THINGS WE
CANNOT SEE... YET!**

In Zechariah 8:20 the Jews were returning from exile to find Jerusalem in ruins and themselves under the control of the Gentile nations. These people have been held captives and forced to serve as slaves and when they are emancipated and return to their homeland, they find the conditions as bad as it can get.

Victory doesn't always look like we think it is going to look! Sometimes our victory comes with a few assembly instructions! We may have to do something to change the picture a little!

In the midst of all this, read chapter eight and see the amazing promises God makes to his people, promises that at the time must have seemed fantastic and unbelievable:

- ***“I will return to Zion and dwell in Jerusalem...”*** (Vs. 3)
- ***“The city streets will be filled with boys and girls playing there...”*** (Vs. 5)

- *“I will save my people from the countries of the east and the west...”* (Vs. 7)
- *“As you have been an object of cursing among the nations, O Judah and Israel, so will I save you, and you will be a blessing...”* (Vs. 13)
- *“I have determined to do good again to Jerusalem and Judah...”* (Vs. 15)

The end of the chapter broadens the promises to include a vast number from the gentile nations! (Vs. 20) ***“Many peoples and the inhabitants of many cities will YET come.”*** This prophetic word is attempting to get them to look beyond their present circumstances to a time when God will bring to pass all that He has promised!

We may not have seen the promise fulfilled YET, but God is not finished YET!

The promise continues in verse 23 *“In those days ten men from all languages and nations will take firm hold of one Jew by the hem of his robe and say, ‘Let us go with you, because we have heard that God is with you.’”*

God is saying to his discouraged people, *“You have no way of knowing what I plan to do through you.”* God acted on behalf of this Jewish audience and He is going to act on our behalf this year!

Just because things seem bad today doesn’t mean they will be bad tomorrow.

God has big plans that we can’t see at the moment, but the day will come when He will bring it to pass.

This should teach us something about:

- The brilliance of God’s plan for us...
- The attention God pays to detail...

- The ability of God to make good on His promises...

Captivity didn't stop Him! Slavery didn't stop Him! Foreigners occupying the land didn't stop Him! Somebody ought to shout it! He is not done YET! He will act on our behalf!

II. WE ARE TO PATIENTLY WAIT FOR WHAT WE CANNOT SEE... YET!

Romans 8:24-25 (NIV) “...*hope that is seen is no hope at all. Who hopes for what they already have? 25 But if we hope for what we do not yet have, we wait for it patiently.*”

Through our trials, God wants to develop two qualities in us:

- Hope
- Patience

Hope is that settled confidence that looks to the future, knowing that God will someday

keep ALL His promises. Patience is the ability to endure present hardship because we have hope for the future.

Paul tells the Romans to rivet their hope into what they do not YET have, and wait patiently for it to come to pass! I encourage us today, to do the same!

We often have to wait for the things that mean the most to us. Someone said, “*The best things in life are worth waiting for.*”

Think of the things that were a long time in coming:

- I waited 14 years for my salvation...
- I waited 19 years for my wife...
- I waited 21 years for my son...
- I waited 29 years for my daughter...
- I waited 42 years for CT Church...
- I waited 52 years for grandchildren...

Psalm 37:7 (NIV) ***“Be still before the LORD and wait patiently for him.”***

Why do we need to wait?

- It strips us of our pride...
- It forces us to cry out to God...
- It kills our arrogance and pride...
- It increases our dependence on God...
- It causes us to focus on the things that really matter...

CONCLUSION:

What is it that we are waiting for? What are we hoping for? While we are waiting, may we never let go of that little word, YET! God will act on our behalf!

Our conversation should sound something like this:

- They are not saved YET!
- I have not received my healing YET!
- I have not been hired YET!
- I have not received my promotion YET!

- The sale is not final YET!
- My financial situation has not changed YET!